# Haruto Matsushima

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## Education

**DePaul University** — Chicago, IL
*Master of Science in Human-Computer Interaction* — *Jan. 2024 – June 2025*

**Chuo University** — Tokyo, Japan
*Bachelor of Laws* — *Apr. 2018 – Sep. 2022*

## Experience

**Product Designer** — Apr. 2026 – Present
*Money Forward* — *Tokyo, Japan*

- Conducted 20+ usability tests and 5+ user interviews during discovery for a new product to uncover user needs and validate product hypotheses.
- Used AI-assisted coded prototyping to rapidly explore concepts, test assumptions, and iterate on product experiences.

**Product Designer (Internship)** — Nov. 2025 – Mar. 2026
*Money Forward* — *Tokyo, Japan*

- Analyzed and proposed improvements to design system components in Figma to better align with engineering constraints.
- Designed pagination redesign concepts and collaborated with PMs and engineers to prepare implementation-ready handoff.
- Developed low-fidelity flows and wireframes for a workplace stress-check application, exploring key user journeys and regulatory constraints.

**UX Researcher / Designer (Internship)** — Sep. 2025 – Nov. 2025
*Marketeq Digital* — *Miami, FL (Remote)*

- Conducted competitive and UX analysis to inform content structure and interface design for a talent marketplace contract flow.
- Translated research insights into wireframes to improve clarity and user confidence during decision-making.

## Academic Projects

**RunBuddy** | *UX Research, Community Design, Human-Centered Design, Mobile Design* — Apr. 2025 – June 2025

- Researched and prototyped a solution to reduce friction in joining running groups by aligning social fit and logistical preferences.
- Conducted surveys, interviews, and affinity mapping to uncover key barriers such as group compatibility, uncertainty, and motivation.
- Designed a mobile prototype in Figma and built a high-fidelity animated walkthrough using Framer to validate core features.
- Validated the design with users and iterated on the flow to improve clarity, inclusivity, and decision-making support.

**ClassCollab** | *UX Research, Lean UX, Design for Startups, Web Design* — Apr. 2025 – June 2025

- Designed and tested a student-focused team formation tool that improves group compatibility in project-based courses.
- Validated key assumptions through a landing page MVP (60% CTR), followed by an interactive prototype tested with seven graduate students.
- Incorporated scenario-based onboarding, team previews, and group overview features to increase confidence and reduce friction.
- Achieved an average System Usability Scale (SUS) score of 82.5, indicating strong perceived usability.

## Skills

**Design Skills**: User Research, Usability Testing, Interaction Design, Wireframing, Prototyping, Information Architecture, User Interviews, Contextual Inquiry, Heuristic Evaluation, Journey Mapping, Personas, Lean UX
**Design Tools**: Figma, Framer, Axure, Adobe XD, Illustrator, Photoshop, Atlas.io
**Programming**: HTML/CSS, JavaScript, Swift
**Languages**: Japanese (Native), English (Working Proficiency)